Google Civic Information API Overview

Research notes | October 27, 2026

Key update

This API is much smaller than it used to be. Google turned down the Representatives API in April 2025, so it can no longer look up the elected officials for an address or division. Older tutorials and apps that use those endpoints are broken now. What is left is **Elections** and **Divisions**.

Endpoints

All requests go to https://www.googleapis.com/civicinfo/v2 and use an API key from Google Cloud Console.

Endpoint	Method name	What it does
GET /elections	electionQuery	Lists the elections you can query: id, name, electionDay, and ocdDivisionId.
GET /voterinfo	voterInfoQuery	The main endpoint. Looks up voting information for a registered address. address is required.
GET /divisions	search	Searches for political divisions by natural name or OCD ID.

What data you get from /voterinfo

- Polling places, early voting sites, and ballot drop off locations, with addresses, hours, and coordinates.
- Contests on the ballot: offices, candidates (name, party, website, social channels), and referendums (title, text, pro and con statements).
- State and local election offices: registration, absentee, and ballot info links, plus hours and contact details.
- Whether the area votes entirely by mail, and the precinct ID.

Limits

- **Coverage:** only elections supported by the Voting Information Project; elections expire after election day.
- **Caching:** without cache-control headers, cache polling place and contest data for 24 hours max.
- **Quota:** increases take one to two months and are only approved for user facing use cases.
- **Status codes:** handle noStreetSegmentFound, addressUnparseable, electionOver, and similar.
- **Testing:** election ID 2000 is Google's permanent test election.

App ideas

- Where do I vote finder with a map.
- Personalized ballot preview with an AI plain language measure explainer.
- Voting plan builder with deadlines and official links.
- Election countdown and calendar reminders.
- Campus or community voter hub.
- District explorer using /divisions.

Representative data alternatives

Use the OCD ID from this API with BallotReady, Cicero, Ballotpedia, or OpenStates (free key, state legislators).

Documentation

- API reference: https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/v2/
- Elections resource: https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/v2/elections
- Data guidelines: https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/data_guidelines
- Representatives turndown notice: https://groups.google.com/g/google-civicinfo-api/c/9fwFn-dhktA
- Cloud Console: https://console.cloud.google.com/apis/library/civicinfo.googleapis.com